

Sanyam Mahajan

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Early-career researcher in Indian digital governance and technology policy

EDUCATION

Ashoka University | Haryana, India | June 2026

Young India Fellow (Postgraduate Diploma in Liberal Studies); CGPA 3.62/4.00

- Awarded the Outstanding Experiential Learning Module (ELM) Award at convocation.

Ramjas College, University of Delhi | New Delhi, India | June 2025

BA (Honours) in Political Science; First Division

PUBLICATIONS

- *Fiction of Consent: Structural Asymmetry and Student Data Under India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act* (with Durgesh Jha), under review with accepted pitch, EPW Engage.
- *Reimagining Policing in Society 5.0: A Look at Cybercrime and Federal Challenges* (with Karthik Bappanad), Takshashila Institution. Runner-up, Best Paper — Law Enforcement and Policing Fellowship. Available on request.
- [From Access to Equity: A Comparative Analysis of the RTE Act and NEP 2020](#), lead chapter in *Beyond Classrooms: Policy and Practice*, Centre for Civil Society.
- [GDPR vs DPDP: A Comparative Analysis on User-Centrism](#), Ramjas Political Review, Vol. 1, No. 2 (double-blind peer reviewed).

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCE

Experiential Learning Module (ELM), Young India Fellowship | Jan 2026 – Jun 2026 | Hybrid

Partner Organisation: Sambhaav Trust

- In a four-member team studying market linkages for the organic produce of smallholder Bhil Adivasi farmers (70+ stakeholder consultations across three states; Outstanding ELM Award), led all secondary research — designing and building a 350+ entry actor–action database of India's organic farming ecosystem.
- Drafted core chapters of the final report handed over to the Trust and authored the certification-regime analysis comparing PGS-India, NPOP, and Jaivik Bharat pathways, recommending the phased PGS-first strategy adopted in the report's final recommendations.

Research Assistant | Dec 2025 – Feb 2026 | Remote

University of Rochester & University of Wisconsin–Madison (PI: Jayana Bedi)

- Assisted the Principal Investigator on a study of administrative corruption and wealth accumulation among Indian civil servants.
- Hand-coded 400+ Immovable Property Returns of civil service officers into a structured Excel schema (properties, locations, mode of acquisition, valuations, filing dates), following an initial scoping exercise mapping IPR data availability across services and batch years.
- Analyzed asset indicators — property location, mode of acquisition, valuation gaps — to identify patterns of potential rent-seeking.

Research Associate, Law Enforcement and Policing Fellowship | Mar 2025 – Nov 2025 | Hybrid

Takshashila Institution

- Led research on reimagining policing systems for digital-era challenges, working directly with Karthik Bappanad (ex-AVP, ReBIT; Head, Centre of Excellence for Cybersecurity, IIT Madras).
- Designed a comparative framework screening 12 nations' policing systems against India's; built a 12-criterion legal-constitutional scorecard for deep analysis of three focus countries (U.S., Germany, Australia).
- Drafted the paper and earned co-authorship for significant intellectual contribution; selected runner-up for best paper in a cohort of professors, IPS officers, and military leadership.

Millennium Fellow | Aug 2024 – Jan 2025 | Fellowship

United Nations Academic Impact & Millennium Campus Network

- Launched Internet on Trust, a Substack newsletter on internet rights and the on-ground impact of government interventions, with a reach of 1,000+ (currently dormant).
- Hosted three panel discussions with policymakers and NGO leaders on internet policy, with combined attendance of 200.

Policy and Communications Aide (Full-time) | Aug 2024 | In-office

Office of Hon'ble Sujeet Kumar, Member of Parliament, Rajya Sabha

- Drafted speeches (for forums including UNICEF and YuWaah), policy briefs, and parliamentary questions on technology policy; three questions were raised in the Rajya Sabha during the Monsoon Session.

Researching Reality Scholar (Full-time) | Jun 2024 – Aug 2024 | In-office

Centre for Civil Society

- Led an independent three-member team in a comparative narrative-policy (POLiFRAME) study of the RTE Act, 2009 and NEP 2020, synthesizing 26 sources into three headline findings adopted as the lead chapter of the Centre's flagship report Beyond Classrooms: Policy & Practice.

Public Policy Intern (Hybrid) | Feb 2024 – Jul 2024 | Hybrid

Centre for Civil Society

- Analyzed 75+ laws across 19 states on the recognition of K-12 schools, mapping legislation against 100 indicators for a comparative analysis of education law.
- Conducted stakeholder consultations with NGO leaders, school principals, and regulators to validate findings.

Policy-in-Action Fellow (Hybrid) | Nov 2023 – Dec 2023 | Hybrid

Young Leaders for Active Citizenship

- Co-authored a 14-page brief on fiscal federalism and central transfers in Bihar, analyzing Finance Commission tables, state budgets, and UDISE+ data; presented to Prof. Manoj Kumar Jha, MP (Rajya Sabha).

Head of Outreach and Associate Editor | Jul 2023 – Mar 2024 | In-office

Ramjas Political Review

- Oversaw editorial, outreach, and design operations for Volume 1, Number 2; the only board member to pass the journal's double-blind peer review as an author.
- Filed for and secured ISSN accreditation (approved after tenure), making RPR the only ISSN-accredited political science journal across the University of Delhi's 90+ colleges.

PROJECTS

PrivacyLens: Chrome Extension | 2026

- Co-developed, in a three-person team, a WCAG-compliant Chrome extension analyzing website privacy policies against the requirements of the DPDP Act, 2023, alongside an accessibility-first companion website.
- Piloted in the YIF course '*Literacy in the Age of AI*' at Ashoka University as an experiential tool for data-protection literacy.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Graduate Certificate in Public Policy (Technology and Society)**, Takshashila Institution (2024): awarded the inaugural Cheistha Kochhar Scholarship (full scholarship, ₹45,000) for high promise in assessing the impact of technological interventions on society.
- **Statistics in Public Policy**, Centre for Civil Society & Microsoft (2024).

AWARDS

- **Outstanding Experiential Learning Module (ELM) Award**, Young India Fellowship, Ashoka University — awarded for the Sambhaav Trust market-linkages study (2026).
- **Runner-up, Best Paper**, Law Enforcement and Policing Fellowship, Takshashila Institution — selected by an independent jury from a cohort including associate professors, IPS officers, army officials, advocates, and forensic scientists (2025).